

Tamlin Love

Barcelona, Spain

tamlinlove.github.io | [GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | Email: tlove@iri.upc.edu

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am a young researcher from South Africa, now working as a PhD student at the Institut de Robotica i Informàtica Industrial (IRI) (under CSIC and UPC) in Barcelona, working on the TRAIL MSCA-DN project. I am passionate about the possibilities for humans and robots to communicate, collaborate and learn from each other. Right now, my primary interests lie in explainable robotics, where robots must explain the reasons for their decisions and beliefs. I am interested not only in how these explanations are constructed, but also in how they fit into broader human-robot interactions. More generally, I am interested in other areas of human-robot interaction, including personalisation and human-in-the-loop learning. I am also an active member and promoter of the African robotics community, and have organised workshops and conferences with the aim of growing robotics on the African continent.

EDUCATION

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya <i>PhD in Automatic Control, Robotics and Computer Vision</i>	Barcelona, Spain 2023 – Present
University of the Witwatersrand <i>Master of Science in Computer Science (with distinction)</i>	Johannesburg, South Africa 2020 – 2021
University of the Witwatersrand <i>Bachelor of Science Honours in Computer Science (with distinction)</i>	Johannesburg, South Africa 2019
University of the Witwatersrand <i>Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (with distinction)</i>	Johannesburg, South Africa 2016 – 2018

Member of the [Perception and Manipulation](#) group at the [Institut de Robòtica i Informàtica Industrial](#) from 2023 - present.
Member of the [Robotics, Autonomous Intelligence and Learning](#) (RAIL) from 2020 - 2023.

RECENT PUBLICATIONS AND PRE-PRINTS

For a complete list, please follow [this link](#).

<u>Temporal Counterfactual Explanations of Behaviour Tree Decisions</u> <i>Tamlin Love, Antonio Andriella, Guillem Alenyà</i> <i>Under review</i>	2025
<u>Measuring User Understanding in Explainable Human-Robot Interaction: A systematic Review</u> <i>Ferran Gebellí, Pradip Pramanick, Tamlin Love, Raquel Ros, Anaís Garrell, Silvia Rossi, Antonio Andriella, Guillem Alenyà</i> <i>Under review</i>	2025
<u>What Would I Do If...? Promoting Understanding in HRI through Real-Time Explanations in the Wild</u> <i>Tamlin Love, Antonio Andriella, Guillem Alenyà</i> <i>2024 IEEE International Workshop on Robot and Human Communication</i>	2024
<u>Towards Explainable Proactive Robot Interactions for Groups of People in Unstructured Environments</u> <i>Tamlin Love, Antonio Andriella, Guillem Alenyà</i> <i>Late Breaking Report @ 2024 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction</i>	2024
<u>Who Should I Trust? Cautiously Learning with Unreliable Experts</u> <i>Tamlin Love, Ritesh Ajoodha, Benjamin Rosman</i> <i>Neural Computing and Applications</i>	2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

Researcher <i>Institut de Robòtica i Informàtica Industrial</i>	2023 – Present <i>Barcelona, Spain</i>
- Working on the <i>TRAIL: TRAnsparent InterpretabLe robots</i> project (project code: HORIZON-MSCA-DN-101072488), a Marie Skłodowska-Curie Doctoral Network project funded by the European Union. - Involves research on explainability, causality, human-robot interaction, and robot perception and decision-making. - Includes extensive use of Python and ROS.	

Sessional Lecturer

University of the Witwatersrand

2022 – 2023

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Managed and taught the 3rd year Software Design courses and co-taught the 1st year Basic Computer Organisation course for the Computer Science undergraduate degree
- Set, oversaw and marked practical and theoretical assessments for the above courses

Backend Developer

BodyBack

2021 – 2022

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Created and maintained the REST backend framework for the BodyBack mobile application

Tutor

University of the Witwatersrand

2018 – 2021

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Tutored a number of computer science and applied mathematics courses for undergraduate and honours students

RESEARCH STAYS

Academic Secondment

PRISCA Lab, Università degli Studi di Napoli

June 2025 – August 2025

Naples, Italy

- This stay at the [PRISCA laboratory](#), under the supervision of Silvia Rossi as part of the TRAIL doctoral network, culminated in the development of the HEXAR framework for hierarchical explainability, implemented on the PAL TIAGo robot, in collaboration with partners from the laboratory and PAL robotics.

Industrial Secondment

ZAL Center of Applied Aeronautical Research

March 2025

Hamburg, Germany

- This stay at [ZAL](#), under the supervision of Martin Gromniak as part of the TRAIL doctoral network, focused on industry exposure. I spent the research stay evaluating the performance of different object detection models on a dataset of cabin damages.

PROGRAMMING EXPERIENCE

Languages : Python, Java, C, C++, Matlab

I have experience working with robots (ARI, Kuri, OTE RealAnt, TIAGo, TurtleBot) and with the robotics operating system (ROS1 and ROS2).

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Organisation

- General chair of the Transparent and Interpretable Robots (TRAIL) Conference in Italy, 2026 ([Website](#))
- Explainable Human-Robot Interaction Special Session @ RO-MAN, 2025
- "3rd Workshop on Robotics and Automation in Africa" at the Deep Learning Indaba in Rwanda, 2025 ([Website](#))
- IEEE "ICRA@40 Africa" satellite conference in South Africa, 2024 ([Website](#))
- "2nd Robot Learning for Africa Workshop" at the Deep Learning Indaba in Senegal, 2024 ([Website](#))
- "1st Robot Learning for Africa Workshop" at the Deep Learning Indaba in Ghana, 2023 ([Website](#))
- "From Specialists to Generalists: The World of Generalised RL Agents" workshop at the Deep Learning Indaba in Tunisia, 2022 ([Website](#))

Conferences and Summer Schools

Deep Learning Indaba (Tunis 2022, Dakar 2024); EASE Fall School (Bremen 2023); ECAI ([Santiago de Compostela, 2024](#)); HRI (Boulder, [2024 virtual](#)); ICANN ([Lugano, 2024](#)); RO-MAN ([Pasadena, 2024](#))

Reviewing

AAMAS 2024; HRI 2024, 2026; ICRA 2023, 2026; ICSR 2023, 2025; IEEE RA-L 2025; IROS 2024; NeurIPS 2022; RO-MAN 2024, 2025

Invited Talks

University of Pretoria 2022; [IndabaX South Africa 2022](#); Saarland University 2024; Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona 2025;

Languages

- English (home language)
- Italian (conversational)
- Spanish (conversational)
- Catalan (basic)